28/08/25

Act East Policy

DATE - 13 November 2014

Announced by PM modi at the 9th East Asia Summit in Nay Pyi Daw, Myanmar.

* With its Act east policy, India hopes to deepen its political, Economic and security relationships with the Countries of Southeast asia and the wider indo pacific. Balancing against rise of China is key driver.

- China - India views the rise of its principal strategic rival as a serious challenge and is forging relationship with country along its periphery to maintain the balance between them.

- ASEAN - Association of Southeast Asian Nations (Brunei, Malaysia, Singapore, Thailand, Cambodia, Indonesia, Vietnam, Philippines, Myanmar, Laos)

Boosting exports with the 10 members is a core plank.

- Australia - China rise has forged india's outreach for a stronger defense partnership.

- Japan - The key regional power shares

india's Concerns over China expansion.

- Northeast India - New Delhi wishes for its remote north-eastern region to serve as a trading hub that connects southeast asia through Myanmar

- South Korea - India wants to deepen trade, investment and security ties with this regional economic power.

Objective

* To promote economic cooperation, cultural ties and develop strategic relationship with countries in the Asia Pacific region.

* Continuous engagement at Bilateral, Regional and multilateral levels.

* Kaladan Multi-modal transit transport project, The India - Myanmar, Thail and trilateral Highway project, Rhi - Tiddim road project, Border haats.

Bhashini

DATE - August 2022

* Bhashini (Bhasha Interface for India) (National language translation Mission) was launched in August 2022 at Gandhinagar, Gujarat.

* AI powered translation platform developed by Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) under National language translation mission

* Implemented by Digital India BHASHINI division

* Currently supports more than 22 languages.

US Tariffs on India

DATE - 02 April 2025

A US tariff structure (dubbed "liberation day") was unveiled on 2 April 2025, beginning April 5 (10%), country specific (9 April).

- Trump announced 10% tariffs on all nations and much higher rates of 50% on individual countries. Will boost the US economy and protect jobs.

What are tariffs?

- A tariff is a duty or tax imposed by a national government, customs territory, or supranational union on imports (or, exceptionally exports) of goods.
- It is a type of protectionist trade policy because it increases the cost of foreign firms to sell in a country.

Example -

Tariffs (%) → →

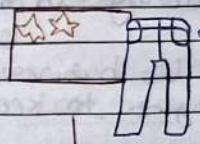
The govt of Canada imposes a 25% tariff on all wheat imports in order to protect domestic wheat producers.

Foreign wheat producers must now pay 25% of the value of the wheat which they export to Canada.

With the increased cost, foreign wheat producers must now increase the price of their wheat in Canada, or incur higher costs.

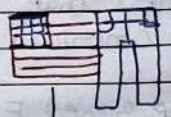
A product 'Jeans' Example -

A Chinese exporter sells a pair of jeans to a US exporter for $10



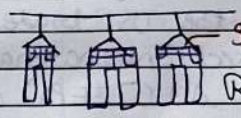
Tariff imposed ← 10% tariff

The US govt imposes a 10% tariff on Chinese products



The US importer will now have to pay $1 extra to the federal government for the jeans increasing its cost to $11

Expenses + profit +$9



$19 (original Retail price)

After adding expenses and profit, the jeans would be sold for $20.

A US customer

Will likely pay more for the jeans

In some cases -

- exporter absorbs the tariffs by lowering their prices

or

- The US business reduces their profit margins to keep retail prices stable

Reciprocal tariffs -

Duties imposed by the US to match the tariffs that other countries place on american goods

* Trump signed Executive order 14257, regulating imports.

* This order declares a national emergency over the US trade deficit and invoked International emergency Economic Power Act (IEEPA) to authorize

* The liberation day tariffs announcement led to a global market crash.

* In response, the white house suspended the April 9 tariffs increases.

* Country specific tariffs to resume on August 7, 2025. 90 day pause was announced on April 9, till July 8.

* It was delayed to August 1. On July 31, trump signed executive order, which ordered country specific reciprocal tariffs resume on August 7.

Tariffs rates on Major countries -

	Region	August 7 (New & (current rate)	April 9 (old & (original proposal rate)
1.	Afghanistan	15%	10%
2.	Bangladesh	20%	37%
3.	Brazil	10%	10%
4.	China	Exempt	34%
5.	India	25%	26%
6.	Indonesia	19%	32%
7.	Myanmar	40%	44%
8.	Pakistan	19%	29%
9.	Thailand	19%	36%
10.	vietnam	20%	46%

Brazil –

Trump began sending letters to foreign government, notifying that the new tariffs would take effect on August 1, unless they reached a deal with US.

* In a letter to Brazil, trump threatened a 50% tariff while criticizing trial of Jair Bolsonaro, an ally of his charged with participating in 2022 coup attempt.

* He eventually imposed a 40% tariff after declaring a National emergency in US caused by Brazil policies, in addition to 10% reciprocal tariff.

India –

25% tariff as a penalty for its purchases of russian oil, in addition to its 25% reciprocal tariff.

Other Countries –

Added :- 30% tariff to imports from Mexico & 35% to those

from Canada.

Implications on India –

1. Significant hit to exports and key sectors –

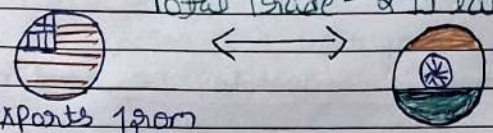
The US tariff will directly impact about 10% of India's total exports, affecting nearly $87 billion worth of goods annually.

* Sectors most at risk include electronics (notably smartphones), pharmaceuticals, textiles, garments, gems and jewellery and automobile components.

* The additional tariff could affect 65% of India's export to US covering sectors like textiles, gems, footwear, gems, chemicals and machinery.

US – India Trade

Total Trade – ₹ 11 lakh crore



Exports from US to India

₹ 3.46 lakh crore

Exports from India to US

₹ 7.35 lakh crore

Items exported: Items exported:

Crude oil, petroleum, Pharmaceuticals,
Coal, diamonds, telecom devices,
Air craft / jewellery,
Spacecraft parts petroleum, Clothing

Source - 2024 United States Trade Representative (USTR)

* India exports more items in US than US does in India. This is called Trade deficit.

* India imports 88% of its crude oil, with over 35% coming from Russia.

Operation Sindoor

30/09/25

DATE - 07 May 2025

Pahalgam Terror Attacks -

Date - 22 April 2025

The "Baisaran Valley" of Pahalgam, Kashmir turned into bloodshed. 4 terrorists openly attacked and fired on a group of tourists.

Led to loss of life of 26 civilians and 20 other people were severely injured.

* The assaulters segregated tourists based on religion, demanding Islamic verses to recognize Hindus before assaulting them.

* The Resistance front, a proxy outfit of Lashkar-e-taiba has claimed responsibility for the attack.

Government response -

5 - point action plan with goal of exerting pressure on Pakistan -

1. Suspension of Indus water treaty -

India has suspended the 1960 treaty.

2. Closure of Attari-Wagah Border Check Post -

The integrated checkpost at Attari in Punjab has been shut down.

3. Revocation of SAARC Visa exemption Scheme for Pakistani Nationals -

Cancelled SAARC Visa Exemption Scheme (SVES) for citizens of pakistan.

4. Expulsion of Pakistani Military Advisors -

Defence, Naval and air advisors stationed at the Pakistani High commission in New Delhi have been declared persona non grata and ordered to leave the country.

India will reciprocally withdraw its own military advisors from its High commission in Islamabad.

5. Reduction in Diplomatic Staff -

Reduced diplomatic personnel in Islamabad from 55 to 30 by 1st May 2025.
This is deliberate scaling down of diplomatic ties.

Operation Sindoor -

Launched in retaliation for the Pahalgam attack, targeting 9 terrorist infrastructure sites in pakistan and pakistan occupied Jamma and kashmir (POJK).

- Wing Commander Vyomika Singh and Colonel Sofiya Qureshi led the indian government briefing about the operation.
- It was a coordinated precision strike operation led by indian armed forces on 7 May 2025.
- Executed through coordinated efforts of Army, Navy and air force.

Name - Sindoor → personal tribute to Victims, particularly widows of the pahalgam attack

High precision Weapons involved -

Indian air force (IAF) used advanced system like -

1. SCALP Cruise Missiles - Stands for "Storm Shadow", a long ranged, air launched cruise missile.

* It was used for deep precision strikes against high value, fixed targets.

2. HAMMER precision Guided Bomb –

Stands for "Highly Agile Modular Munition extended Range" was used for targets requiring medium range precision, such as dynamic or mobile terrorist sites.

3. Loitering Munitions –

Also known as "kamikaze drones" used for surveillance and target engagement, loitering over enemy territory before executing precision strikes.

01/10/25

Ahemdabad Plane Tragedy

DATE – 12 June 2025

Air India flight AI 171 – a Boeing 787 – 8 Dreamliner aircraft crashed into a medical college at distance of 1.7 km from the runway.

* Crashed at BJ Medical College residential complex, close to the Meghani area.
* Going from Sardar Vallabhai Patel International Airport in Ahemdabad to Gatwick Airport in London, about 4200 km.
* The plane was filled with 1.25 lakh liters of fuel for the distance of 100 km. Weight of plane was 227 tons.
* Chief pilot – Captain Sumit Sabharwal (8,200 of flying experience),
* First Officer – Clive Kundar (1100 flying hours)
* 242 passengers (230 passengers, 10 crew members, 2 pilots).
* 169 Indian, 53 British, 7 Portuguese, 1 Canadian.
* All died while one person survived, seated

in 11A, near the emergency exit gate. He was thrown outside the plane during the crash.

* 265 deaths has been confirmed.

* The disaster unfolded 2-3 minutes after the takeoff.

Causes behind the Crash -

1. Plane height and speed -

The plane reached a height of only 825 feet and its speed was only 174 knots (320 km/h), whereas Boeing 787 needs a speed of atleast 200-250 knots at this weight.

2. Landing gear was not retracted -

Videos show the aircraft flying at low altitude with its landing gear still deployed - which is highly unusal.

* This indicates either a critical system failure or cockpit distraction.

3. Fuel control switches -

* Crash was caused by both engines

losing thrust after their fuel control switches moved from RUN to CUTOFF seconds after liftoff.

DATE - 24 July 2025

To mark the UN designated International Year of Cooperatives (IYC) 2025, India unveiled the National Cooperation policy to transform cooperative sector into a people driven economic force.

Theme 25 - "Cooperatives build a better world"

Key features -

1. Vision and Objective -

It supports the Ministry of Cooperation mandate of "Sahakar se Samriddhi".

2. This policy replaces the National policy on cooperatives in 2002 and sets the course for cooperative growth over next two decades (2025 - 2045).

2. Convergence of Government Schemes -

Leverage existing government schemes such as Dairy Infrastructure Development Fund (DIDF), PM Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY) and the National programme for Dairy Development (NPDD) to establish 2 lakh new

multipurpose primary Agricultural Credit Societies (M-PACS) within 5 years.

Member Economic Participation • Autonomy and Independence • Education, Training and Information

Democratic Member Control • Cooperative principles • Cooperation among Cooperatives • Concern for Community

Voluntary and open Membership

Flowchart - Cooperative principles

3. Inclusive Growth and Employment -

Focusing on Dalit, Adivasis, Women and Youth.

4. Diversification -

Expand to over 25 sectors like dairy, fisheries and foodgrain procurement.

What are Cooperatives -

Autonomous association of persons united voluntary to meet their common economic, social and cultural needs, and aspirations through a jointly

owned and democratically controlled enterprise.

- They follow principle of "one member, one vote"

The boom of Cooperatives in India

8.44 lakh Cooperative Societies

30 Sectors

73,492 PACS proposed for computerisation

667 cooperatives societies has been registered as buyers on GeM

59,920 PACS onboarded to a unified ERP platform

2986 transactions have been taken place, amounting Rs 315.02 crore on GeM

23,173 new multipurpose PACS have been registered.

Data - Cooperatives Value Economically

02/10/25

UNESCO Tentative Sites

DATE - 12 SEPTEMBER 2025

The permanent delegation of India to UNESCO announced on 12 Sep 25 the addition of seven natural heritage sites to India's Tentative list.

This expansion increases India's total count on the Tentative list from 62 to 69 properties, comprising 49 cultural, 17 Natural, and 3 Mixed Sites.

* The Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) serves as nodal agency for the world heritage convention in India.

Seven Natural Treasures -

1. Geological Heritage of St Mary Island Cluster, Karnataka -

Off Malpe Coast, features 88-million year old rhyolithic lava formations, providing insights into Indian subcontinent continental drift and a unique example of volcanic history.

2. Deccan traps at Panchgani and Mahabaleshwar, Maharashtra -

A massive geological formation in

Kayna wildlife — Sanctuary, exemplifies the delicate balance between geological significance and biodiversity conservation.

3 Meghalayan Age Caves, Meghalaya —

The Mawmluh Cave, a designated global boundary stratotype section and Meghalayan Age point, houses stalagmites revealing a 4200 years old mega drought, providing valuable insights into climate history and geological process.

4 Naga Hill ophiolite, Nagaland —

This site in Kiphire district offers unique insights into oceanic crust and plate tectonics, and is home to four key biodiversity areas, supporting vulnerable species.

5 Natural heritage of Tirumala hills, Andhra pradesh —

A geological, ecological and spiritual site boasts the Eparchaean Unconformity, 1.5 billion years old Natural Arch formation, endangered species habitat, and annual pilgrimage.

6 Erra Matti Dibbalu (Red Sand Dunes), Andhra pradesh —

A unique coastal geographical formation near Visakhapatnam, contains a unique archive of earth dynamic history.

7 Varkala Cliffs, Kerala —

Reveals the Mio-pliocene Warkalli formation revealing tropical weathering and tectonic uplift, and serve as natural water harvesting system and unique plant species habitat.

06/01/26

VB-G RAM G Bill, 2025

DATE - 16 December 2025

Full form → Viksit Bharat - Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin)

This Bill was introduced in Lok Sabha on 16 Dec and passed on 18 Dec.

* It seeks to replace the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA), 2005 with a new statutory framework.

Key features

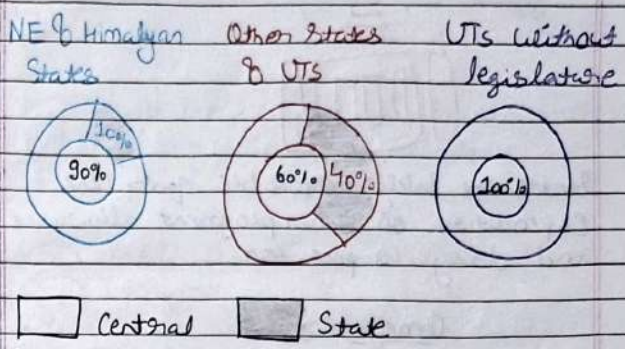
1. Enhanced employment guarantee - 100 previous to 125 days now

2. 4 priority sectors - water security, rural infrastructure, livelihood infrastructure & climate resilience.

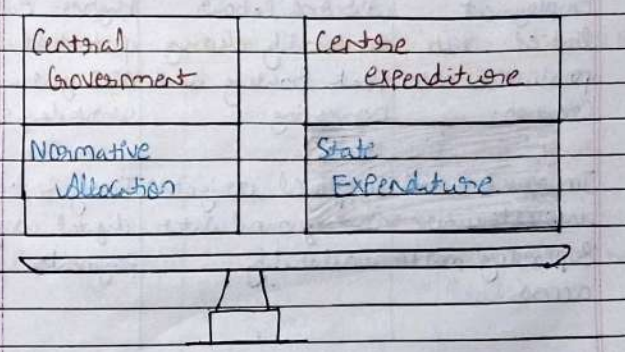
3. Strong transparency & oversight - AI based monitoring, real-time dashboards and mandatory social audits

The financial architecture - A centrally sponsored scheme with shared responsibility -

01: Fund Sharing pattern



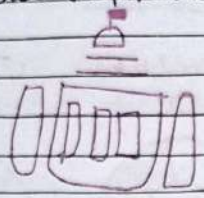
02: Key financial principle : Normative Allocation



The central government will determine a statewise normative allocation each year based on objective parameters.

This supports sound budgeting.

03: State Responsibility



States are solely responsible for the expenditure on unemployment allowance and delay compensation.

Benefits

Rural Economy	Farmers	Labourers
1. Employment linked with productive asset creation.	Assured labour availability during peak sowing and harvesting.	Higher earning potential with 125 guranteed workdays
2. Improved rural infrastructure supporting market access	Improved irrigation and groundwater availability	Timely & transparent digital wage payments

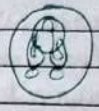
Technology driven Governance for Transparency & Accountability –

To modernize governance, accountability and citizen engagement through a comprehensive digital ecosystem

Biometric Authentication

Geospatial Technology

Real-Time Monitoring


proactive public disclosure

Artificial Intelligence

Strengthened Social Audits

Comparison of MGNREGA (2005) Vs VB-GRAMG Bill (2025) –

	Feature	MGNREGA (2005)	VB-GRAMG Bill (2025)
1.	Guranteed days	100 days	125 days
2.	Funding (wages)	100% central funding	60:40 (Centre: State)
3.	Core philosophy	Rights based / demand driven	Mission-mode / Supply-driven
4.	Agricultural impact	Year-round (often led to labor shortages)	60-day mandatory pause for sowing / harvesting

5.	planing unit	Labor budget	Viksit Gram panchayat plans (VGPP)
6.	Technology	Basic MIS / Aadhaar payments	AI fraud detection / GPS / National Infrastructure stack
7.	Payment frequency	Paid within 15 days of work completion	Paying wages weekly to improve cash flow

06/01/26

DATE - 03 JANUary 2026

U.S military forces launched a large scale operation Codename operation absolute Resolve against Venezuela, bombing targets in Capital Caracas and capturing president Nicolas Maduro and his wife, Cilia Flores, before flying them to the United States.

* The attack drew intense global reaction, with Venezuelan officials condemning it as an abduction and violance of sovereignty.

* The Constitutional Chamber of Venezuela's Supreme Court ordered vice president Delcy Rodriguez to serve as acting president following the US's abduction of Maduro.

Numbers -

* More than 150 aircraft launched from across the western hemisphere including F-18, F-22 and F-35 fighter jets, B-1 bombers and drones.

* US service members operation target is age 20-49.

* Maduro will face trial

Months of escalating tensions -

US military has carried out 35 known strikes on what Trump has said were drug carrying boats that killed at least 115 people in early September.

* On Dec 29, Trump said US struck a facility where boats accused of carrying drugs "load up". First known operation on venezuelan soil since US began strikes.

* US also offered a $50mn reward for information leading to Maduro arrest.

Reasons for the attack -

1. Drug Cartels - According to US president, venezuelan drug cartels are threat to US national security. He has branded Maduro a "narco-dictator".

2. Migrants - Trump alleged that South american nation had sent a significant number of prisoners including individuals from mental health facilities, into US.

Close to 8 million venezuelans have fled the country's economic crisis since 2013, reports the BBC.

3. Oil, wealth and geopolitics behind strike -

The country holds world's largest reserve of extra-heavy crude, much of it in the orinoco belt. While expensive to process, this oil is compatible with US refineries.

Venezuela Oil reserves -

largest proven oil reserves in the world, approx 303 billion barrels of crude oil, according to Organization of the petroleum Exporting countries (OPEC).

* Accounts for 17-18% of global proven oil reserves, highest by single country.

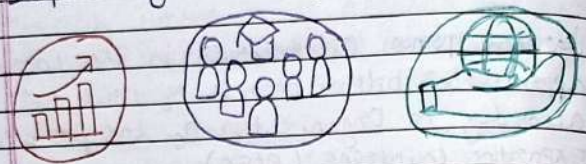
US president is insisting the US needs full access to Venezuela's oil & Natural resources.

04/02/26

DATE - 01 FEBRUARY 2026

Present by finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman her second ninth consecutive budget presentation.

First union budget prepared is Kartavya bhawan (Central secretariat new name).
Inspired by 3 kartavyas (duties)-



Growth Human Capacity Universal Access

1. ₹53.5 lakh crore total expenditure - Non-debt receipts projected at ₹ 36.5 lakh crore

2. 4.3% fiscal deficit target - down from previous year 4.4%

3. ₹12.2 lakh crore public capital expenditure

Net tax receipts - ₹28.7 lakh cr
Debt to GDP - 55.6% (Ratio)

Kartavyas & Schemes -

1. First Kartavya:- Manufacturing & Growth -

- Biopharma SHAKTI launch - ₹10000 crore outlay over 5 years.

- India Semiconductor Mission 2.0 - full stack Indian IP equipment production.

- ₹40,000 crore for electronics components

- seven high speed rail corridors - Mumbai-Pune, Pune-Hyderabad, Hyderabad-Bengaluru, Hyderabad-Chennai, Chennai-Bengaluru, Delhi-Varanasi, Varanasi-Siliguri

2. Second Kartavya:- fulfill aspirations and build capacity of people -

- high powered 'Education to employment and enterprise' standing committee.

- 100,000 Allied health professionals to be added over next five years.

- five regional medical hubs.

3. Third Kartavya :- Sabka Sath Sabka Vikas -

- Integrated development of 5000 reservoirs & Amrit Sarovars.

- Govt. to support high value crops

- Bharat VISTAAR, multilingual AI tool.